

STARTUP VALIDATION CHECKLIST

15 Essential Steps to Validate Market Demand Before Writing Code

PHASE 1: PROBLEM SPACE VERIFICATION

- ☐ **Problem Definition:**
Write a clear, one-sentence description of the target user's core pain point.
- ☐ **User Interviews:**
Interview 15+ potential users about their workarounds, without pitching your solution.
- ☐ **Pain Ranking:**
Confirm that this specific problem ranks in the target customer's top 3 active priorities.
- ☐ **Workaround Audit:**
Document all existing workarounds, including spreadsheets, manual labor, or other tools.
- ☐ **User Persona Map:**
Create a detailed profile of the primary customer segment experiencing this pain point.

PHASE 2: SOLUTION & V1 SCOPE DEFINITION

- ☐ **Minimum Viable Experience:**
Identify the single core interaction that delivers the primary value to the user.
- ☐ **Feature Trimming:**
Strip out 80% of secondary features (nice-to-haves) from the V1 release scope.
- ☐ **Target Stack Choice:**
Select an optimized stack (No-Code vs. Custom Next.js) based on budget & timeline.
- ☐ **Success Metric:**
Define one clear quantitative metric (e.g. user retention, repeat usage) for success.
- ☐ **Velocity Deadline:**
Define a strict development timeline aiming for V1 launch within 4 to 8 weeks.

PHASE 3: DEMAND & MARKET VALIDATION

- ☐ **Value Proposition:**
State your solution's core offering in one simple, high-converting headline.
- ☐

Landing Page Smoke Test:

Build a single landing page explaining the product and capturing early intent.



Call-To-Action (CTA):

Include a strong intent-based signup form (e.g., pre-order or waitlist entry).



Traffic Generation:

Drive 200+ highly targeted prospective users to the page using organic or paid channels.



Demand Proof:

Achieve the conversion benchmark (e.g., >10% signup rate or initial paid deposits).

READY TO VALIDATE AND BUILD YOUR MVP?

Book a free discovery session with FirstMileDev to architect your launch.

BOOK CALL NOW